

LOOKING FOR A GOOD HOSTING PROVIDER? FOLLOW THESE TIPS!

Web hosting is getting increasingly common, yet it is a complex task. In order to make an informed choice, an IT head should look into some key aspects before inking the deal.

The market for hosting services in India is growing exponentially. The cloud is the current buzzword and everyone wants to get onto the bandwagon to adopt it. Anil Chandaliya, head, data centre operations, ESDS Software Solution Pvt Ltd, shares, "Over a period of time, the industry has proven itself and matured, having delivered what was committed. Every business house wants to focus on its core business and strengths and, therefore, wants hosting providers to take care of IT infrastructure. Additionally, in this fast paced technology world, business models are changing dynamically. New business models are emerging almost daily and are completely based on technology. E-commerce, m-commerce, mobile banking, GPS-centric businesses, IoT based solutions, video-centric businesses, etc, are some examples of the same. Such business models require huge investments in IT infrastructure (CAPEX), and so customers adopt services from hosting providers based on the OPEX model."

Many multinational service providers are now coming to India to offer hosting services. Global providers like

Microsoft, Amazon and Rackspace have already announced their plans to start their data centres in India. This trend will continue as the number of Internet users in India is growing rapidly and, shortly, could exceed 500 million. India is soon expected to rank amongst the top three nations with regard to the number of Internet users. In order to address these users, global providers will keep moving to India. Government initiatives like the Digital India programme, National Knowledge Network (NKN) and NOFN (National Optical Fibre Network) will also help to grow this segment. Domestic companies are also making heavy investments to start more data centres.

So, the market for hosting services is poised to grow along with the needs of the IT heads. While there are enough options already available, it might be difficult for IT heads to gauge the best hosting solution provider for their firm. Here are a few questions that need to be answered, prior to making a decision:

- How do you ascertain whether the Web hosting service chosen is actually good?
- Which type of hosting service is most apt for the organisation's needs?

